

Zainab Ismail

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London

Writer and software engineer with a background spanning literature, digital publishing and front-end development — now seeking to bring that breadth of experience to copywriting. I studied English Literature with Creative Writing at degree level, and my work has appeared in numerous magazines and anthologies. My debut poetry pamphlet, *Ecstatic Motion*, explores movement, identity and culture — a project that required both artistic vision and precision of language. Years in digital publishing and the creative tech industry have honed my instinct for clarity, precision and technical understanding combined with sophisticated sensitivity to the reader's experience. I am ready to channel those skills into producing compelling copy.

WRITING & PUBLICATIONS

Ecstatic Motion — *Poetry pamphlet published by Marble Poetry in 2020*

An original collection of poetry, exploring themes of tricultural heritage, identity and personal history while demonstrating a distinctive voice and command of form, imagery and storytelling.

Pave the Way with Concrete Poetry — *The Poetry Society/Young Poets Network website*

Educational article written for a wide online readership during an internship at The Poetry Society — demonstrating the ability to write engagingly for a defined audience.

Wretched Strangers — *Boiler House Press, anthology*

Poem 'Sharp Relief' published in this anthology and selected for study and translation at the Crossing Borders, Reaching Home workshop at St Anne's College, University of Oxford — a celebration of language, identity and the movement of words across cultures.

Work published across a range of literary magazines and anthologies.

EXPERIENCE

Wonderbly

Software Engineer · Apr 2020 – Feb 2026 · London

- Crafted personalised children's books in a creative tech environment — combining an awareness of typography and design principles with technical execution.
- Built interactive documentation, components and content tools, requiring clear, user-focused writing alongside precise implementation.
- R&D into ambitious, complex design briefs — developing a strong appreciation for the interplay between copy and image.

HarperCollins Publishers

Digital Content Assistant · May 2018 – Apr 2020 · London

- Edited, proofread, and produced ebook backlist titles across a broad range of genres, rigorously following technical standards.
- Converted complex books into accessible digital formats, requiring attention to detail and sensitivity to visual presentation.
- Automated accessibility and production processes by developing plugins, demonstrating technical initiative and aptitude for problem-solving and efficiency.

The Poetry Society

Marketing, Education & Publishing Intern · Aug 2017 · London

- Supported marketing and administration for a major international poetry competition.
- Wrote educational content published on the Young Poets Network, demonstrating confidence in writing for a defined audience with a clear, authoritative tone.

EDUCATION

University of Greenwich

BA English Literature with Creative Writing, First Class Honours · 2015 – 2018

- University Merit Award for Outstanding Achievement
- Best Performance Award — Year 1, Year 2 & Year 3

SKILLS & INTERESTS

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| · Copywriting | · Digital publishing (ebook, web) |
| · Proofreading & editorial | · Social media content |
| · Creative & experimental writing | · HTML / CSS / Javascript / React |